

cumstance of considerable importance. In the first half of the year also there is more floating capital spread out, and more disposition to extend credit to catch the profits that are to be gathered when the nations of the earth are enticed into activity and movement, both for business and pleasure, by genial weather and long days.

*A speculator should have a good aneroid
barometer . . . and he would not be very far
wrong if he were to buy and sell according to the
indications given by this instrument . . .*

As regards some stocks, there will be no need to make a special study of causes which affect the dividend; but this is not the case with railway stocks. A speculator in railway stocks must watch the course of trade, the colonial produce, the Manchester and Liverpool markets, and note the character of the business doing in the great staples of Industry. Upon the profitable nature of these trades depend very much the traffic receipts of railways. A speculator devoting his attention especially to railway stocks will, of course, analyze the reports of the various companies, carefully noting the weekly published traffic receipts. Then, again, there are the northern iron and coal districts, the operations in which affect the price of railway stocks in two ways which are obvious. A speculator who operates solely in railway stocks should be posted from hour to hour in such matters, or he will be assuredly "hung up," as the saying is, with stock on which he has made a loss.

Whether there be any more rise or not left in public securities as a body after the turn of the half-year,—we are speaking from a bull point of view, as that is the way in which the public, in ninety-nine cases out of a hundred, operate,—we should always recommend a speculator to pack up his traps and go right away, whether he has won or